

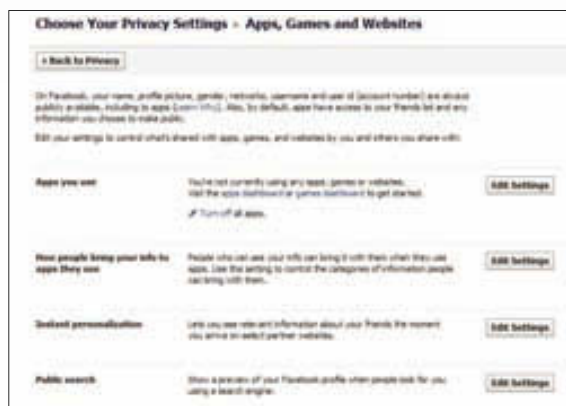
ment tags and who can make tag suggestions, and finally, whether friends can check you in to different places using mobiles. “Apps and Websites” determines just how much information you share with third party websites and applications. You can also edit “Public Search” and “Instant Personalization”. The latter is especially interesting since it accesses public info related to you and your friends’ interests on select websites that Facebook is partnered with. If you’re feeling especially paranoid about other people seeing your views on different sites, you can disable this feature.

“Limit Audience for Past Posts” is fairly straightforward. Since Facebook’s privacy settings can be adjusted for individual posts, this option allows you to change all past posts to whatever settings you’ve created under “Friends”. If you’ve made something public before, however, and want to keep it that way, you’ll have to go to the post in question and change it separately. Finally, there’s “Blocked People and Apps”. This is the page where you can block annoying users or applications, and is fairly useful since it pretty much erases any evidence of either, no matter where you go.

Standard Do's and Don'ts with Facebook

Do's

- Keep as little information of your profile viewable to the public as possible. Limit messaging and friending options to “friends of friends”.
- When logging into Facebook, always make sure it's via a secure “https://”.
- Avoid clicking on suspicious links or allowing third party apps to access your profile. There are greater dangers than just letting the whole world know you play Farmville.
- Limit the privacy of your posts to “Friends” rather than “Friends of Friends”. The extent of one's connections



Facebook offers three privacy settings for your discretion, though you'll still need to do some fine-tuning.

- can never truly be known. Keep things within a circle you know you can trust.
- Disabling the public search option can improve your social security by leaps and bounds. This prevents anyone from viewing your profile via any search engine. It's imperative to do this before you start Facebooking full time so that none of your information is cached within the search engine when you decide to disable it.
- If you're logging from a cyber café, keep in mind that dozens of users come in every day, and it's no secret they can be a major breeding ground for key-loggers, worms, etc.
- Several sites allow you to log in to your Facebook account to like and comment on posts. Always make sure the source is trustworthy before doing so, and even then think twice about it.
- Disable viewing of your default profile pic for everyone except your friends. This seems elementary, but this often how imposters get rolling. On another note, be careful of people you think you recognize but who have only one or two pictures on their profile and a scarcity of information.

Don'ts

- You should never post your phone number or physical address on Facebook. In extreme cases where you must, make sure it's viewable to a circle of friends that you trust.
- Never, ever, ever divulge any sensitive information to anyone on

Facebook, for any reason whatsoever. This rule applies to information regarding your account, email, and bank details.

- If there's a video or picture you only want a few people to see, it's safer to simply not upload it.
- Never use the same log in password for Facebook as you do for your email address or other services. This is even more so in the case of the email. If your Facebook password is lost or compromised, you still have the chance to change it via a notification it sends to your email account. If both passwords are the same, it wouldn't be difficult to have someone lock you out all together from your own account.
- Don't simply friend some one based on the “one mutual friend” connection. Even in lists of a 100+ friends, there will always be someone your friend can't completely vouch for. Always make sure you know the person in real life, and communicate via messages first before trusting them with viewing your profile and information.
- And most importantly, never click on each and every link you see on Facebook, especially the ones that ask you to navigate away from the site.

Online Identity Management and its Benefits

You can use online identity management or online personal branding to deter any possible imposters. It involves publicly participating in forums and being brought up in news items and social media. This presence you create is somewhat different from keeping information about yourself away from crackers and snoops. Take for example, famous celebrities and politicians officially cementing their presence on Twitter. It not only allows the site to weed out fake accounts, but can be a great source for legitimacy if some one's causing trouble in your name. Just make sure to keep sensitive information out of the disclosure. 